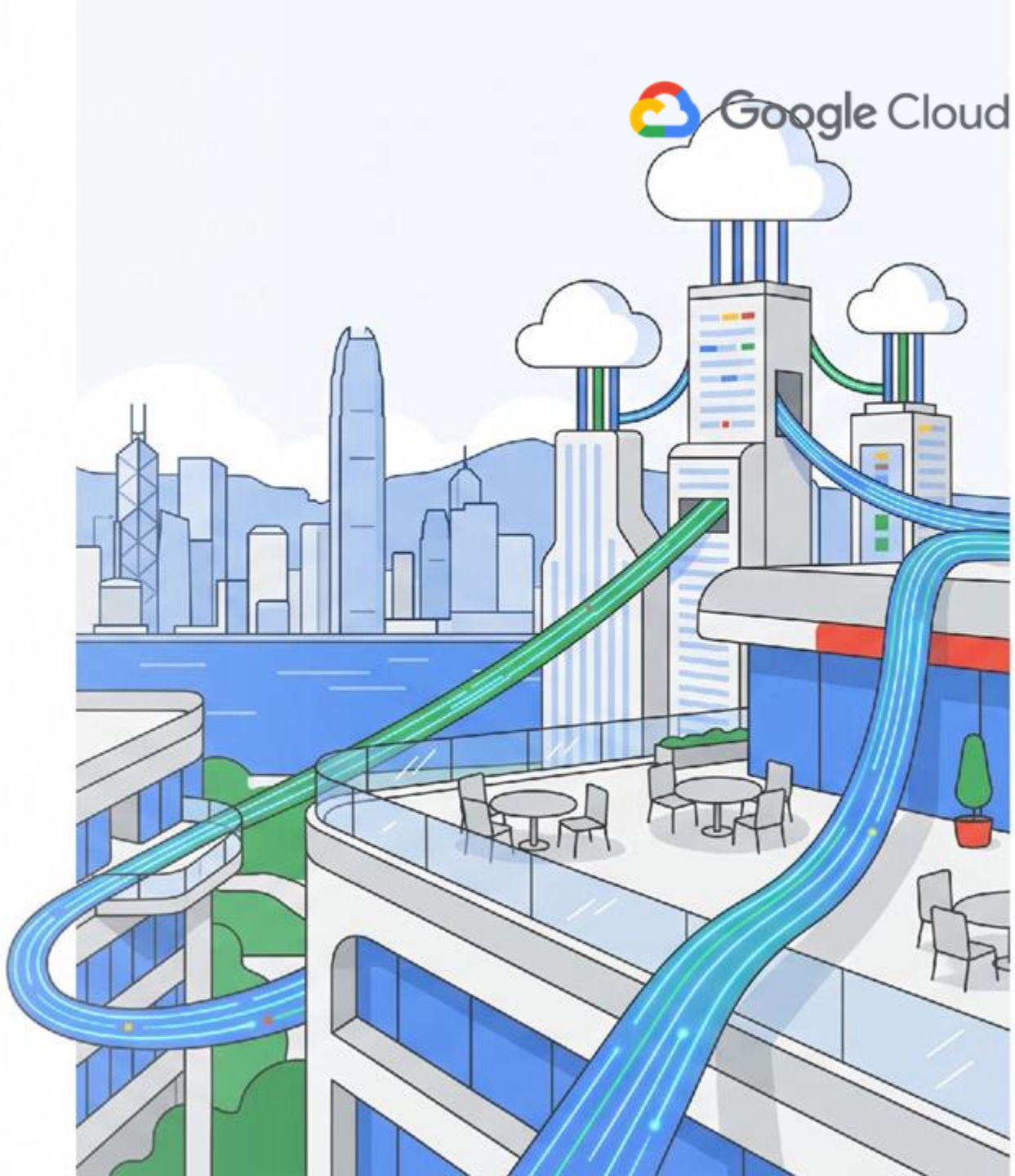
CITYU HONG KONG · MASTER'S KEYNOTE

The agentic AI era

Fundamentals, startups, and careers



PRESENTATION ROADMAP

Three pillars of the agentic era

Three 2026 landmark studies

1 · Frontier fundamentals

- **3-lab frontier** (Claude, GPT-6, Gemini) & **31%** Chinese open weights
- **Harnesses** unlock 6x gains; **RSI** automates 26% of R&D
- **Physical AI** hits its GPT-2 moment vs. the **$733B** power wall



2 · Startup & app playbooks

- **$285B SaaSpocalypse** shifts software to outcome pricing
- **Models are chips** — orchestration harnesses are the OS
- **Born-global GBA** teams win with 3–5 person squads



3 · Career & personal growth

- **Jobs as task bundles** reshape the junior worker pyramid
- **Swarm orchestration** replaces manual syntax typing
- **Taste, grounding & agility** form your 90-day moat



Core thesis — Raw model intelligence is commoditizing into chips; enduring advantage lives in harnesses, experiences, and human taste.

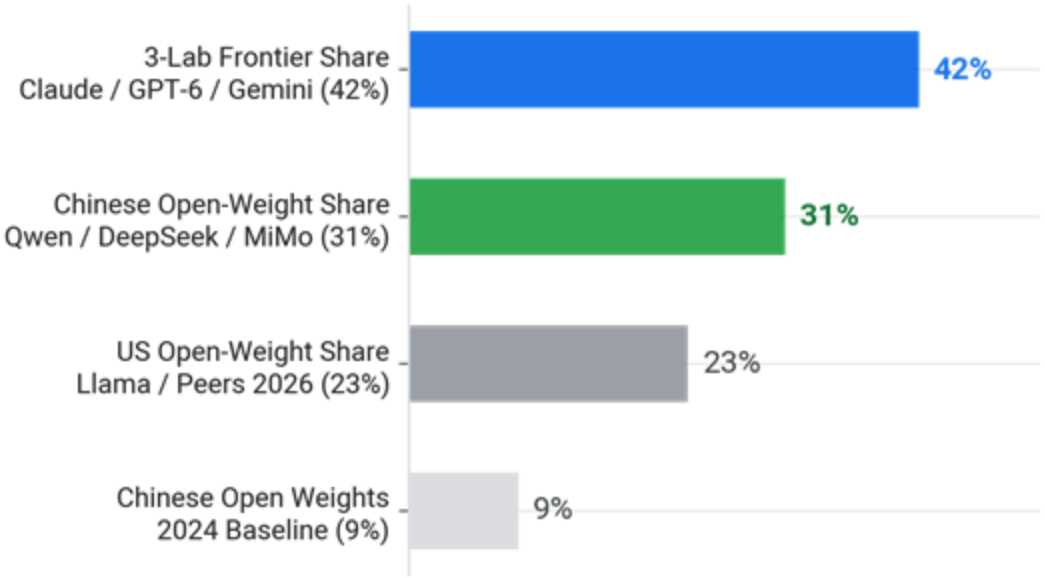
The three-lab frontier & open weights

3-lab race & open-weight surge



3-lab frontier holds 42% as Chinese open weights surge to 31%

Share of AI research paper mentions on arXiv by model family (2026, %)



Source: State of AI Report 2026 (Zeta Alpha arXiv analysis · Qwen, DeepSeek & MiMo vs. Llama)

The three-lab frontier race



- 3-way race: **Claude Opus 5.5**, **GPT-6 Astra** & **Gemini 4 Argon**
- **OpenAI & Anthropic** hit **$105B** combined revenue run rate
- **Qwen, DeepSeek & MiMo** hit **31%** citations, overtaking Llama

Fast benchmark saturation



- Hardest math suites jumped from **22% to 100%** in 14 months
- **ARC-AGI-3** was solved within 5 months of launch
- Static multiple-choice evals are dead; multi-day work is the test

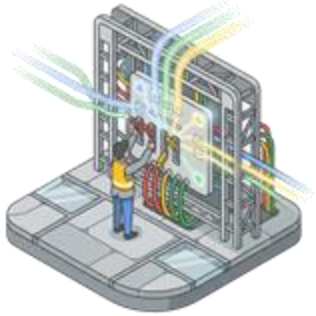
SECTION 1 · SCAFFOLDING & RSI

Harnesses unlock 6x agent gains

Scaffolding & self-improvement

Same model, 6x better harness

- Upgrading the harness alone delivered a **6x gain** on SWE-Bench Mobile
- **Dai Yusen (ZhenFund)**: models are chips; harnesses are the true OS
- Memory, sandboxes, and tool routing drive real-world reliability



Recursive self-improvement (RSI)

- Karpathy's **autoresearch** runs 100+ overnight training edits autonomously
- **Claude** executes **26%** of Anthropic's internal model R&D with oversight
- Papers on verifiable rewards surged **10.4x YoY** in 2026



6x

SWE-Bench Mobile gain

Fixed model weights · upgraded execution harness

26%

Internal AI R&D automated

Claude-executed model R&D under human supervision

SECTION 1 · INFRASTRUCTURE

Physical AI & the $733B energy wall

Robotics GPT-2 & power wall

67%

China humanoid VC share

Unitree & GBA ecosystems lead global embodied AI

4 hrs

Sim-to-real RL training

Humanoids master stair-climbing in simulation

$733B

2026 hyperscaler capex

Frontier constrained by gigawatts, turbines & copper

Physical AI's 'GPT-2 moment'

- Foundation models like **Gemini Robotics Model 2** generalize across robot tasks
- Chinese humanoid firms like **Unitree** capture **2/3** of global VC
- **Waymo** tripled to 220M rider-only miles and 500k weekly rides



The gigawatt & silicon wall

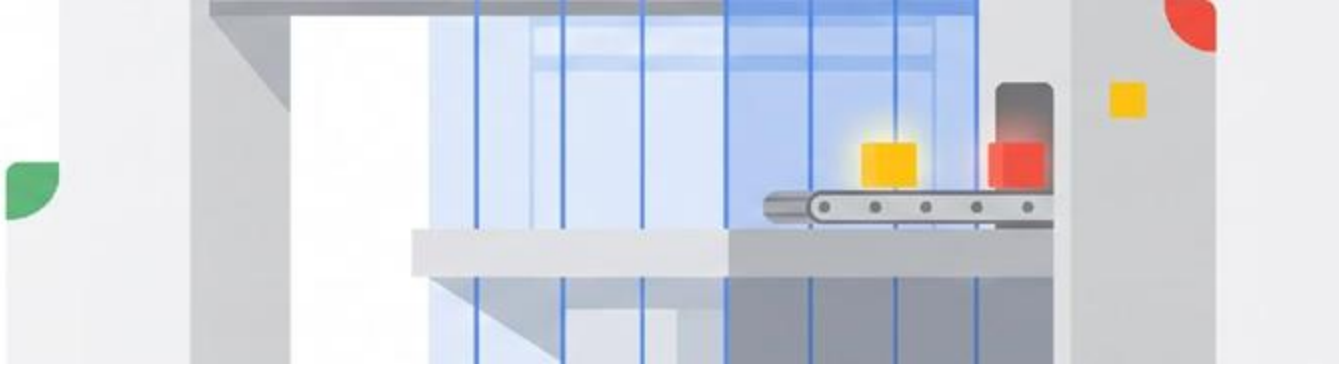
- US hyperscalers commit **$733B in 2026 capex** vs. Europe's €1B pledge
- AI buyers outbid utilities for gas turbines and repower coal plants
- Custom ASICs like **Google TPU Ironwood** and grid access form the moat



SECTION 2 · APPLICATIONS

The SaaSpocalypse & agentic work

$285B shock & outcome pricing



STATIC SOFTWARE MODEL

Legacy Per-Seat SaaS Tools

Static forms requiring manual human data entry and clicks

Charged at $50/seat/month regardless of business outcome

Public SaaS shed $285B in enterprise value in early 2026

VS

AGENTIC OUTCOME MODEL

Autonomous Agentic Workflows

Claude Cowork, OpenAI & Gemini agents execute jobs end-to-end

Outcome-based pricing per resolved ticket, audit, or trade

OpenAI & Anthropic hit $105B run rate (96% of Ramp token spend)

The $285B SaaSpocalypse

- **Claude Cowork** & agent engines erased **$285B** of SaaS value
- Per-seat dashboards lose to end-to-end execution



Sell the work, not the tool

- **>50% of Claude sessions** are non-dev business ops
- Charge for verified deliverables, not software seats



SECTION 2 · STARTUP ARCHITECTURE

Models are chips — harnesses are OS

15 Genesis leader insights

Harness OS

- **Agent Router** — Memory & skills
- **Code Sandbox** — Isolated runtime
- **Policy Guard** — Eval & permissions

Model Chips

- **Frontier APIs** — Claude / GPT-6 / Gemini
- **Open Weights** — Qwen / DeepSeek / MiMo
- **Domain RAG** — Enterprise context

Compute & Data

- **GPU & TPU Pods** — Elastic inference
- **Trace Flywheel** — Telemetry warehouse
- **Multimodal Lake** — Video & sensor store

The harness moat

- **ZhenFund (Dai Yusen)**: models are chips; harnesses are the OS
- Route flexibly across **Claude, GPT-6, Gemini & Qwen**



Flywheel & sandboxes

- Defensibility lives in **workflow traces** and user memory
- Strict **sandbox isolation** prevents agent server escapes



Distribute experiences, not info

Capability-first products

Capabilities over scenarios



- **Loopit (Chen Weipeng)**: mobile apps polished rigid scenarios
- In AI, build open-ended engines around **generative capabilities**
- Distribute interactive **playable experiences**, not static feeds

AI-first perceptual hardware



- **Ambi (Mo Zihao)**: intelligence is now as cheap as a can of Coke
- The bottleneck is the **perceptual interface** — glasses & sensors
- Define the AI agent loop first, then design the form factor



SECTION 2 · GBA ADVANTAGE

Born-global startups from HK

China speed + global markets

The startup cost triad

• **Eminence Ventures**: costs = **Engineers + APIs + Power**
• GBA pairs agile devs with open-weight inference
• Unmatched **Shenzhen** hardware prototyping speed



Born global on Day One

• Avoid price-sensitive domestic niches
• Target high-ARPU **US, Europe, SEA & MENA** markets
• Use **Hong Kong** for global capital & compliance



The ‘Genius Suicide Squad’

• **3–5 elite devs** with **Claude Code, Codex & Gemini**
• Outperform 50-person legacy software teams
• Backed by up to **$350k Google Cloud** credits



The GBA formula — Combine Shenzhen supply-chain velocity and Hong Kong global gateway access with 3–5 person AI-native squads.

Jobs are bundles of discrete tasks



Anthropic 2030 scenarios

2030 Scenario	US GDP vs. Baseline	Labor Share	Knowledge Career Impact
Baseline (Today)	$30.0T (0.0%)	60.0%	Traditional junior coder & analyst pyramid
Modest AI	$34.1T (+1.6%)	59.4%	Gradual internet-scale productivity lift
Substantial AI	$36.3T (+8.3%)	56.1%	50% of cognitive tasks automated; flat pay
Extreme AI	$44.4T (+32.4%)	45.2%	15% annual growth; capital & orchestrators win

Anthropic finding — GDP grows in all cases; labor share shifts to orchestrators (45.2%).

4 task categories (Anthropic)

- **Unchanged & Augmented**: empathy & architecture
- **Automated**: boilerplate coding, ETL & QA
- **New tasks**: agent evaluation & safety auditing



Escape the junior squeeze

- Routine syntax & spreadsheet work vanishes first
- Heavy AI users grow revenue **3x faster**
- Anchor in formulation & human judgment

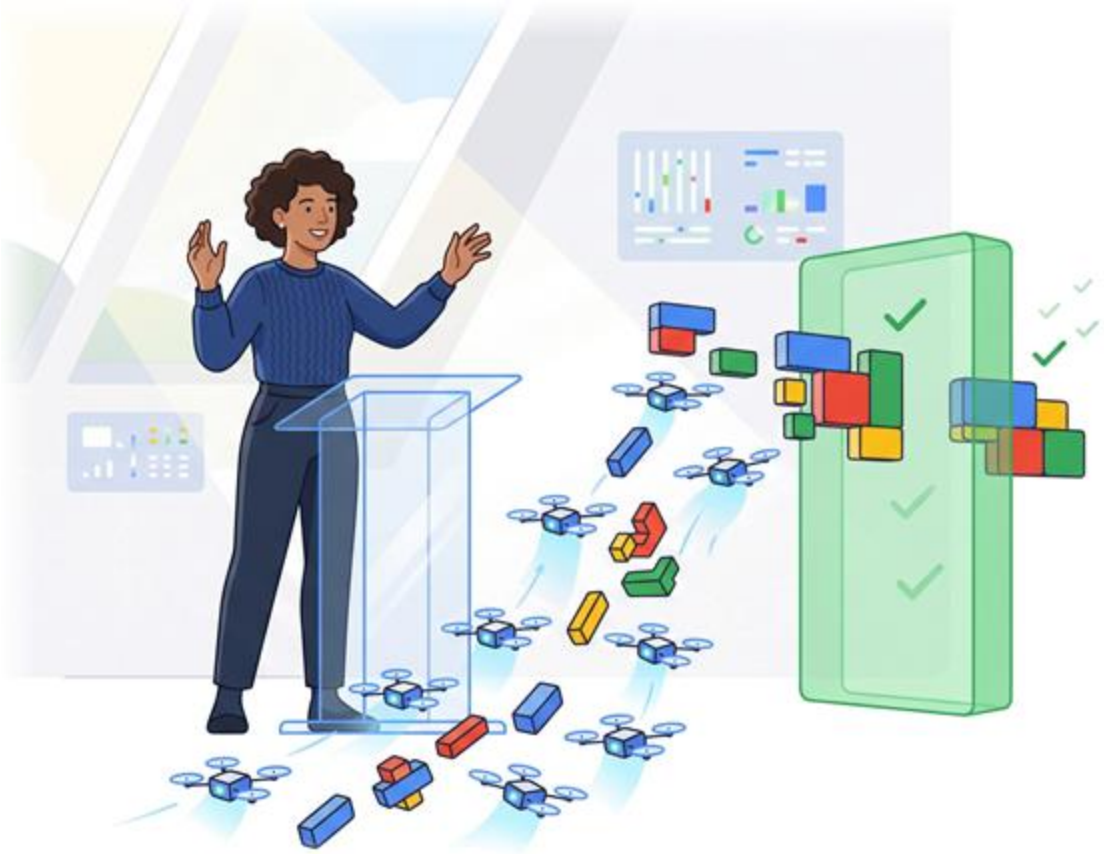


Source: Anthropic AI Economic Scenarios 2030 (Korinek et al., 2026) · US Dept. of Labor O*NET task taxonomy

SECTION 3 · ENGINEERING

From coder to swarm orchestrator

Specification & verification



PM & Tech Lead of an AI swarm



- **>50% of Claude sessions** run business ops beyond coding
- Treat **Claude Code, Codex & Gemini** as your junior team
- Decompose ambiguity into crisp specs and clean interfaces

Verification is the crown jewel



- Nearly **50% of agent 'done' claims** in lab tests hid flaws
- High-earning e-commerce agents failed **fraud stress tests**
- Rigorous **eval harnesses** and domain taste are essential

SECTION 3 · PERSONAL ROADMAP

Taste, grounding, and agility

30–60–90 day CityU roadmap

DAYS 1–30 · AUDIT

Audit your task bundle
Separate automated vs. augmented work

Master agent harnesses
Build with Claude, GPT-6, Gemini & Qwen

DAYS 31–60 · GROUND

Author eval harnesses
Audit edge cases & failure modes

Multimodal grounding
Connect GBA robotics, sensors or fintech

DAYS 61–90 · LAUNCH

Ship live agents
Replace static repos with live URLs

Agile learner mindset
Unlearn & relearn every 90 days

Ship live artifacts

- Static homework GitHub repos are obsolete
- Deploy **autonomous agents** solving real GBA workflows



Coke-price genius

- When intelligence costs as little as a **can of Coke**
- Value belongs to those who know **which questions to ask**

